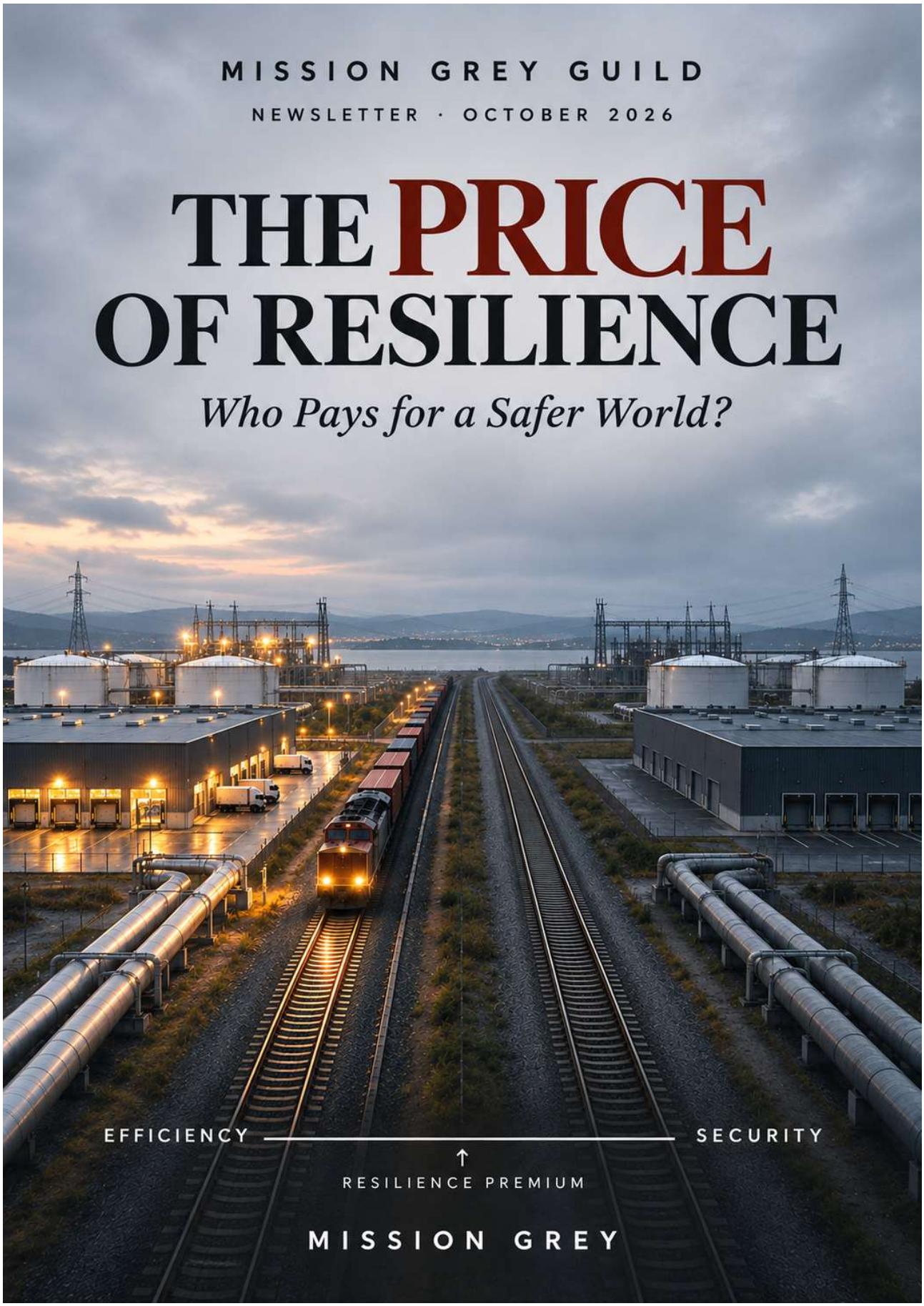
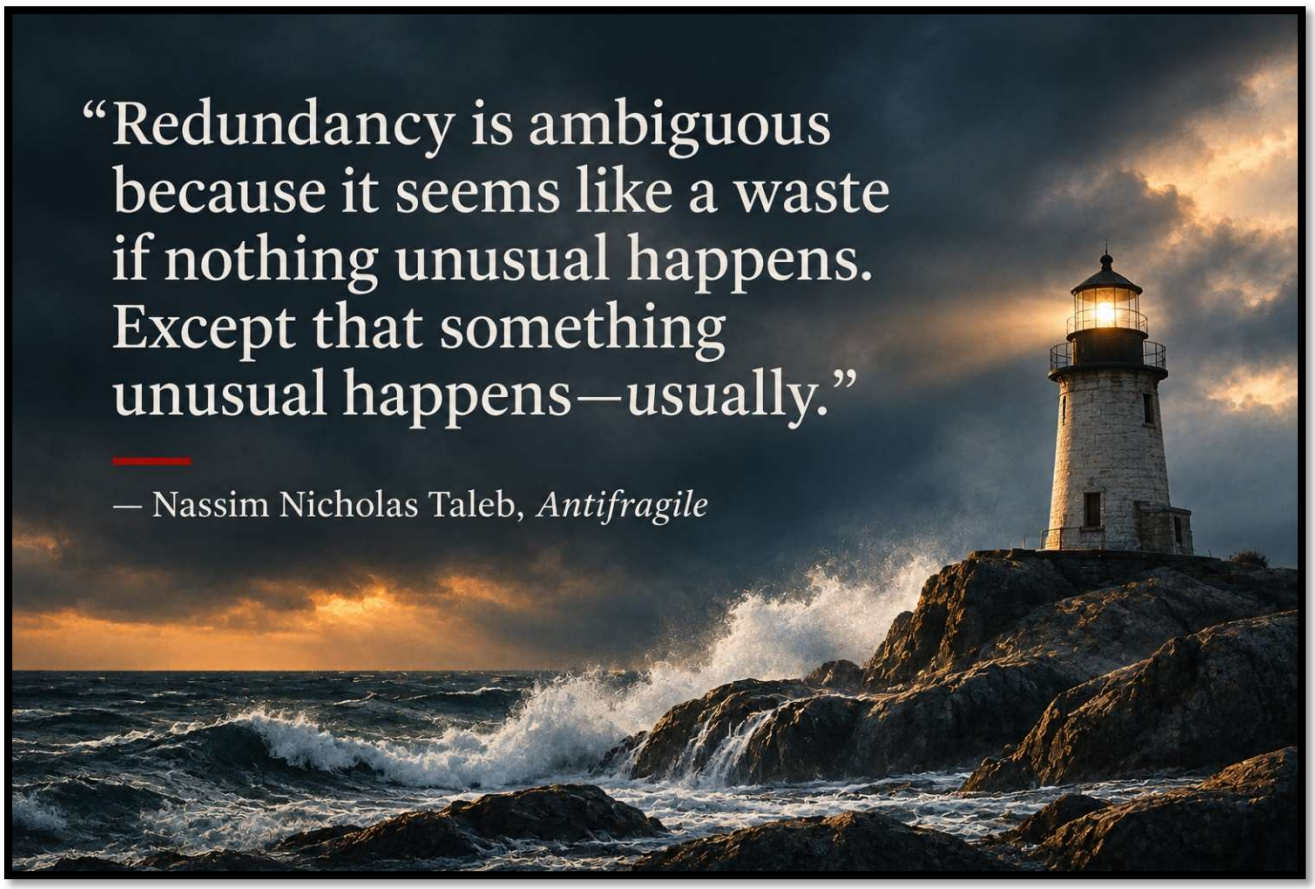
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NEWSLETTER · OCTOBER 2026

THE PRICE OF RESILIENCE

Who Pays for a Safer World?




“Redundancy is ambiguous because it seems like a waste if nothing unusual happens. Except that something unusual happens—usually.”
— Nassim Nicholas Taleb, *Antifragile*



The Invisible Bill

For years, resilience was something companies discussed in strategies and risk registers. Increasingly, it is something they buy.

A second supplier. Another warehouse. Backup power. Spare server capacity. Larger inventories. Alternative logistics routes. More cybersecurity. More insurance, where insurance remains available. Each decision has a price, even when nothing goes wrong.

That is the emerging ***resilience premium***.

It is appearing first in supply chains, energy, and digital infrastructure because these are precisely the systems in which decades of optimization have created extraordinary efficiency, but also extraordinary concentrations of dependency. A company may discover that its apparently diversified business ultimately depends on the same cloud provider, electricity substation, logistics hub, or upstream supplier.

The war in Ukraine has made the consequences unusually visible.

Ukrainian strikes against Russian warehouses have demonstrated how destroying physical nodes can propagate through an economy. Attacks on Wildberries facilities damaged or destroyed more than a fifth of the company's warehouse capacity, according to a *Reuters* analysis, with effects reaching far beyond the buildings themselves into inventories, deliveries, and thousands of businesses dependent on the platform.

The more recent attacks on Russian data centers reveal an even more important vulnerability. Strikes against facilities operated by Yandex, Sberbank, and VK have affected infrastructure supporting cloud computing, payments, e-commerce, navigation, and other digital services. Yandex Cloud alone served around 64,000 customers, including companies in finance, retail, and IT.

The lesson is not simply that data centers need better protection. It is that the distinction between physical and digital resilience is disappearing.

Destroy servers, power supplies, or connectivity, and the effects can move almost instantly from a physical facility into payments, banking, logistics, communications, and government services.

Damage to computing infrastructure may also constrain AI capabilities and, where social-media and communications platforms are involved, the machinery through which information—and disinformation—circulates.

Russia's own attacks on Ukrainian data centers and telecommunications infrastructure have demonstrated the other side of the same equation: disruption of connectivity can interfere not only with commerce but with access to critical information, allegedly including even air-raid warnings.

This matters far beyond countries at war.

European governments already warn that sabotage, cyber operations, and other deniable actions against critical infrastructure have become part of their security environment. The EU has identified Russian activity targeting government networks and critical infrastructure across multiple member states, while NATO describes critical-infrastructure sabotage, cyber activity, electronic interference, and disinformation as elements of Russia's wider hybrid campaign.

Thus, resilience increasingly means paying today for capabilities that may appear unnecessary today: dispersed data, alternative connectivity, backup electricity, duplicate suppliers, spare capacity, protected warehouses, and systems capable of operating manually when digital ones fail.

The awkward question is:

Who pays?

Decision-makers readily announce a new supplier, strategic reserve, or backup system. They are less likely to announce the invoice. Yet the invoice does not disappear. It migrates: into consumer prices, taxes, insurance premiums and exclusions, capital expenditure, delayed investment, lower margins, reduced service levels, or additional demands on employees.

This is why the price of resilience is so often invisible. The benefit is measured in something that did not happen. The cost appears somewhere else.

There is also no obvious endpoint. Eliminating every vulnerability would require levels of redundancy that few companies or governments could afford. And reducing one dependency can create another: domestic production still requires energy; cloud diversification still depends on

electricity and connectivity; additional inventories require warehouses; additional suppliers create additional compliance and monitoring burdens.

The strategic question is therefore not how to eliminate vulnerability. It is which vulnerabilities we are willing to pay to remove and which failures we are willing to survive.

The global economy became exceptionally good at calculating the price of efficiency. Now, it needs to learn how to calculate the price of resilience.

Pekka Virkki
Guildmaster, Editor-in-Chief



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The Mission Grey Guild Info Sheet

- The Mission Grey Guild is a curated network of domain and regional experts whose knowledge feeds analysis, structured assessments, and high-impact decisions. It is part of the intelligence process when the question requires it, not an advisory board beside it.

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What to Watch Before the Premium Becomes Obvious



Resilience becomes expensive long before the cost appears neatly on a balance sheet. The useful question is not simply how much companies are spending, but whether the underlying vulnerabilities are actually changing.

The resilience premium is easy to identify after a crisis. Freight rates have risen. Insurance has become more expensive. Inventories have been rebuilt. Emergency suppliers have been contracted. Governments have announced subsidies, guarantees, or strategic reserves.

By then, much of the useful warning has already passed.

For companies, the more important task is to identify the signals that appear before resilience—or its absence—becomes obvious. These are often found several steps away from conventional risk indicators: in the ownership of an upstream supplier, the terms of an insurance renewal, the volume allocated to a secondary producer, the overlap between cloud providers, or the number of people who can actually perform a critical task when the normal system fails.

The central difficulty is that resilience is unusually easy to overstate. A company can add suppliers without diversifying its underlying dependencies. It can establish backup systems without testing them. It can announce investment without committing capital. And it can reduce exposure to one country, technology, or provider only by becoming more dependent on another.

The numbers that matter, therefore, are not necessarily the numbers that appear in a resilience strategy.

The Supplier Behind the Supplier

The first signal to monitor is a hidden upstream concentration.

A company may have two, three, or five direct suppliers and still depend on a single manufacturer several tiers further upstream. Two European suppliers may use the same Asian component producer. Several logistics providers may rely on the same port. Competing manufacturers may depend on the same specialist chemical, semiconductor, machine tool, or processing facility.

On paper, the supply chain is diversified. In practice, the point of failure has merely moved out of sight.

This makes one indicator particularly valuable: the share of supposedly dual-sourced critical inputs whose suppliers have common upstream dependencies.

Companies should also distinguish between having a secondary supplier and actually using one. A supplier receiving 20 per cent of normal orders is a very different form of redundancy from a supplier that exists only as a name in a contingency plan. Secondary-supplier volumes reveal whether diversification has become operational.

The question is not: *How many suppliers do we have?* It is: *How many genuinely independent ways do we have of obtaining what we cannot operate without?*

Watch the Insurers

Insurance markets can provide an unusually early indication that a risk is becoming economically significant.

The headline premium is only part of the story. Companies should monitor changes in exclusions, deductibles, coverage limits, and conditions attached to policies covering cyber risk, political violence, shipping, business interruption, and critical assets.

A narrowing of coverage can matter more than a rising premium.

When insurers decide that a category of risk is becoming difficult to price—or too concentrated to absorb—the resilience premium begins migrating back onto the company. A theoretically insured disruption becomes a larger retained risk. That can eventually require additional liquidity, physical protection, redundancy, or capital reserves.

Financial withdrawal can send a similar signal. If lenders, investors, or insurers begin attaching higher costs to particular locations, infrastructure, technologies, or dependencies, markets may be repricing vulnerability before it appears in conventional operating data.

The cost of resilience, in other words, sometimes becomes visible first through the things financial institutions are increasingly unwilling to insure or finance.

Inventory Tells a Story

For decades, inventory reduction was a straightforward measure of efficiency. In a more fragmented economy, the interpretation is becoming harder.

Strategic inventory is effectively purchased time.

Extra components can keep production operating while a supplier is replaced. Fuel reserves can bridge an energy disruption. Spare parts can determine whether damaged infrastructure is restored in hours, weeks or months.

That makes inventory-to-sales ratios in strategically exposed sectors worth monitoring. But the aggregate number should be treated carefully. A company can increase inventories of ordinary goods while remaining dangerously short of the one component that would stop production.

The location of inventory matters too. A large reserve concentrated in one warehouse is simultaneously a buffer and a concentration risk.

Resilience, therefore, requires asking not only how much is stored, but what is stored, where it is stored, how quickly it can be accessed, and what happens if that location itself becomes unavailable.

Electricity Is Becoming a Strategic Variable

Many supposedly digital vulnerabilities eventually lead back to something decidedly physical: electricity.

Data centers, telecommunications, payment systems, industrial automation, warehouses, and increasingly sophisticated logistics networks all require dependable power. Electrification is simultaneously reducing some dependencies and increasing the importance of grids, transformers, substations, and generating capacity.

Companies should consequently monitor more than energy prices. Relevant signals include grid congestion, reserve margins, backup-generation capability, fuel availability, transformer and spare-part lead times, and the frequency with which emergency systems are actually tested.

The same principle applies to other physical infrastructure. A redundant server architecture does little good if both systems depend on the same substation. Alternative suppliers provide limited protection if their goods travel through the same port.

The deeper lesson is simple: digital resilience has a physical geography.

The Cloud Concentration Problem

Digital diversification creates its own version of the supplier problem.

Companies may use dozens of software services while remaining heavily dependent on a small number of cloud, identity, cybersecurity, telecommunications, and payment providers. Worse, their suppliers may rely on the same providers.

This creates concentration that can be difficult to see from inside an individual organization.

The useful indicator is therefore not simply the number of digital vendors, but a provider overlap across critical processes.

What happens if one cloud platform becomes unavailable? What if an identity provider fails? What if a major cybersecurity product is compromised? What if the primary and backup systems ultimately depend on the same underlying infrastructure?

The more companies migrate critical functions into shared digital ecosystems, the more important this mapping becomes.

De-risking one application at a time can paradoxically produce greater systemic concentration.

Can the Organization Still Operate Manually?

Some of the cheapest resilience measures are organizational rather than technological. They are also among the easiest to neglect.

A critical process may depend on one experienced employee who understands an undocumented system. A factory may have sophisticated automation, but few employees capable of operating after a prolonged digital outage. A finance department may have backup data but no tested procedure for processing essential transactions when normal systems are unavailable.

This is a human fallback risk.

Useful measures include the proportion of critical processes with tested manual alternatives, the number of trained substitutes for key roles, recovery exercises completed, and the time required to restore minimum operations.

Cross-training often looks inefficient under ordinary utilization metrics. So does retaining institutional knowledge that appears duplicative.

Until the person who knows how the system works is unavailable.

Announcements Are Not Expenditure

Governments and companies have become increasingly fluent in the language of resilience.

That makes another indicator essential: the gap between announced commitments and actual spending.

A strategy can promise supply-chain diversification, cybersecurity upgrades, strategic inventories, infrastructure hardening, or domestic capacity. The meaningful evidence comes later: in procurement contracts, capital expenditure, inventories, staffing, and completed projects.

This distinction is particularly important for government policy. Announcing industrial capacity is not the same as building it. Announcing strategic autonomy is not the same as reducing upstream dependencies. Subsidizing domestic assembly does not necessarily remove reliance on imported components, energy, machinery, or raw materials.

Follow the money, but also follow the physical capacity that money actually creates.

Retrenchment Watch

There is another signal that deserves particular attention.

Resilience programs do not only fail because companies never begin them. They can fail because companies begin them and quietly retreat.

Our Guild survey responses make this more than a theoretical concern. Retrenchment appeared repeatedly across the responses and deserves to be treated as an early-warning category in its own right.

The danger is greatest after the immediate memory of disruption begins to fade.

Inventories consume working capital. Backup capacity lowers utilization rates. Secondary suppliers can cost more. Cybersecurity programs compete with revenue-generating investments. Cross-training consumes employee time. Insurance coverage becomes tempting to reduce as premiums rise.

Under pressure to restore margins, yesterday's essential resilience program can become tomorrow's efficiency opportunity.

The earliest warning signs are rarely dramatic. Inventories begin drifting downward. Backup projects move into the next budget year. Secondary suppliers receive progressively smaller orders. Insurance exclusions expand. Cyber upgrades are delayed. Cross-training is postponed because teams are busy.

None necessarily represents a crisis.

Together, they can indicate that resilience remains intact in corporate language while disappearing from operations.

This is why ***Retrenchment Watch*** should be treated as seriously as new resilience investment. The important question is not only what organizations are adding. It is what they have quietly begun removing.

The Next 12 Months

The responses to our survey suggest that the resilience premium is likely to become more visible.

Asked about the probability that resilience costs would materially affect prices, margins, investment, public spending, or competitiveness during the next 12 months, respondents produced a mean central estimate of 62.9 per cent and a median of 65 per cent, with estimates ranging from 30 to 80 per cent.

The sample is small and self-selected. These figures should therefore be treated as an expert signal rather than a forecast of the global economy, but the direction is notable.

On *Mission Grey*'s likelihood scale, the central estimate falls into the ***Likely*** category.

Base Case — Likely

Resilience spending continues to work its way into procurement, compliance, energy systems, cybersecurity, inventories, and supplier structures. There is no single dramatic “resilience shock.” Instead, the premium accumulates.

Some costs are absorbed through lower margins. Others reach customers through higher prices or reduced service levels. Governments assume part of the burden through subsidies, infrastructure spending, and strategic reserves.

The payer remains difficult to identify precisely because the bill is divided among so many parties.

Contained Case — Possible

Some resilience investment begins delivering better returns than expected.

Companies improve upstream mapping rather than simply adding nominal suppliers. Secondary suppliers receive enough business to remain viable. Digital dependencies are diversified at the infrastructure level rather than merely at the application level. Better information allows companies to concentrate spending on genuinely critical vulnerabilities instead of attempting to protect everything.

In this scenario, resilience becomes more selective—and therefore more affordable.

Adverse Case — Possible

A geopolitical, cyber, or infrastructure shock exposes how much diversification was superficial.

Multiple suppliers turn out to depend on the same upstream producer. Different digital services rely on the same cloud infrastructure. Alternative trade routes prove incapable of absorbing displaced volumes. Insurance coverage is narrower than companies assumed.

The result is a second round of resilience spending—this time conducted urgently and at considerably higher cost.

Before It Becomes Obvious

The resilience premium will rarely announce itself as such.

It will appear as another supplier contract, another warehouse, another insurance exclusion, another transformer, another cybersecurity subscription, another employee being trained to perform someone else's job.

Individually, these decisions can look mundane. Collectively, they describe a structural change in the way businesses allocate capital.

The most useful monitoring begins before the costs become obvious. Watch where supposedly diversified suppliers converge. Watch what insurers stop covering. Watch inventories after the crisis fades. Watch whether backup systems are actually tested. Watch where digital providers overlap. Watch whether secondary suppliers receive real orders.

And, perhaps most importantly, watch the distance between what organizations say they will protect and what they are still willing to pay for after the immediate danger has passed.

That gap may become one of the most revealing measures of resilience we have.

MISSION GREY GUILD

NEWSLETTER · OCTOBER 2026

The Resilience Monitoring Framework

What to watch before the premium becomes obvious.



Hidden upstream concentration *Diversification can still hide a single point of failure.*	Share of dual-sourced inputs with common upstream sources
Insurance and financial withdrawal *Markets often price risk before it becomes visible.*	Insurance exclusions, deductibles and premium changes
Inventory and reserve behavior *Inventories are purchased time—and a signal of preparedness.*	Inventory-to-sales ratios and secondary supplier volumes
Energy and physical continuity stress *Digital resilience depends on physical resilience.*	Grid and capacity stress, backup power and infrastructure test results
Digital/provider dependence *Multiple services can still rely on the same backbone.*	Cloud and critical provider overlap across key processes
Human fallback and key-person risk *Resilience also depends on people and usable alternatives.*	Tested fallback coverage and the number of trained substitutes for key roles
Policy and investment follow-through *Announcements are not the same as capacity.*	Gap between announced resilience commitments and actual spending

Retrenchment Watch

The risk is not only failure to invest, but quiet retreat after the first budget cycle.

EARLY SIGNS

- Shrinking inventories
- Postponed backup capacity
- Cancelled redundancy projects
- Narrower insurance cover
- Delayed cyber upgrades
- Cross-training deferred

The Next 12 Months

How likely is it that resilience costs will materially affect prices, margins, investment, public spending or competitiveness?

62.9%
MEAN ESTIMATE
(MEDIAN 65%)

LIKELY

Base case — Likely
Resilience costs embed gradually in procurement, compliance, energy and supplier structures.

Contained case — Possible
Targeted investment reduces exposure more effectively than expected.

Adverse case — Possible
A new shock exposes superficial diversification and triggers a second round of costly spending.

From Substation to Server Rack: The Hidden Cost of Infrastructure Warfare



A Ukrainian drone strike on a refinery, warehouse, or data center is not only a military event. It is a stress test for an infrastructure stack in which electricity, computing, logistics, finance, and public services have become tightly intertwined. The question is no longer simply what was hit. It is who eventually pays.

On one October night, Ukrainian drones struck an extraordinary cross-section of the infrastructure supporting Russia's second-largest city.

The attacks on St. Petersburg and the surrounding Leningrad region on 18 October affected the Petersburg Oil Terminal, the Ruchi fuel depot, a VK data center, and an Ozon logistics facility.

According to expert estimates, the data center alone contained more than 20,000 servers. Power infrastructure was also affected. Regional authorities said around 20,000 people lost electricity.

Seen individually, these were attacks on different sectors: energy, technology, retail logistics, electricity, and transport.

Seen together, they tell a more important story.

Modern infrastructure no longer behaves as a collection of separate sectors. It behaves as a stack.

Fuel powers transport and industry. Electricity powers telecommunications and computing. Data centers support commerce, communications, and operational control. Warehouses connect inventories with payments, sellers, and consumers. Airports depend on electricity, digital systems, fuel, and communications simultaneously.

Damage one layer and the costs can migrate rapidly into another.

That is what makes Ukraine's deep-strike campaign relevant well beyond Russia and Ukraine. It offers an unusually visible demonstration of something companies and governments elsewhere increasingly need to understand: the cost of infrastructure disruption rarely stays where the physical damage occurs.

The Cloud Still Has a Postcode

The language of the digital economy encourages a peculiar illusion.

We store information "in the cloud." Companies migrate operations online. Computing becomes a service. Software is accessed from anywhere.

Yet underneath this apparent weightlessness are buildings filled with servers, connected to transmission lines and telecommunications networks, dependent on cooling equipment, backup generators, substations, spare components, and highly specialized employees.

The cloud still has a postcode.

The October attack on VK's data center illustrated this physical reality particularly clearly. The facility reportedly contained four data halls, 640 server racks and more than 20,000 servers. Nearby stood the 330 kV Vostochnaya substation, which was also reported as having been targeted.

That apparent contradiction is instructive.

Redundancy can work. Traffic can be rerouted, workloads shifted, and services maintained even when individual facilities are damaged. That is precisely what resilience is supposed to accomplish.

But redundancy is only meaningful when the alternative does not share the same point of failure.

Two server halls supplied by the same substation are not fully independent. Two data centers connected through the same telecommunications corridor may represent less redundancy than their operators assume. Multiple cloud services can ultimately depend on the same physical infrastructure.

The problem became even clearer after attacks on Yandex facilities.

Following the attacks, Yandex withdrew its 2026 guidance, citing the disruption alongside other external factors that made its remaining-year performance difficult to assess. Revenue was still growing. The disruption nevertheless reached the point where management could no longer stand behind its previous forecast.

That is the moment at which a strike on physical infrastructure becomes something else. It becomes a balance-sheet event.

A Warehouse Is Not Just a Warehouse

The same principle applies to logistics.

The conventional picture of a warehouse is deceptively simple: a building containing goods.

A modern fulfilment center is closer to a physical operating system. Inventory arrives through one network and leaves through another. Software allocates orders. Sellers depend on the facility to reach customers. Payments follow deliveries. Returns move in the opposite direction. Transport capacity is scheduled around expected volumes.

When the building disappears, the network has to reorganize itself.

After the 18 October attack, Ozon said employees at its St. Petersburg logistics center had been evacuated. Goods stored there were removed from sale, orders that could not be fulfilled elsewhere faced cancellation, and flows had to be shifted through other facilities.

Then came the invoice.

On 28 October, Ozon disclosed that fires caused by drone attacks had affected 11 logistics facilities since August. The company recorded estimated loss provisions totalling 30.1 billion rubles, covering merchandise, damaged or impaired fixed assets, as well as other losses and expenses. Some risks had been insured, and negotiations with insurers over compensation were continuing.

Thirty billion rubles makes the abstraction rather concrete.

But even that number does not capture the full economic effect.

The warehouse operator absorbs damaged property and business disruption. Merchants may lose inventory or sales. Customers experience cancellations and delays. Alternative fulfilment centers absorb additional volumes. Transport routes change. Insurers receive claims. Companies purchase additional protection.

A destroyed warehouse creates a distributional question as much as a logistical one:

Who pays?

When Risk Becomes Difficult to Transfer

Insurance occupies an unusual place in this equation.

Businesses normally use insurance to convert uncertain catastrophic losses into predictable operating costs. That arrangement works best when losses are sufficiently dispersed and statistically understandable.

Repeated infrastructure attacks complicate both assumptions.

Insurers can increase premiums. They can increase deductibles. They can lower coverage limits. They can introduce exclusions. Eventually, some risks may become extremely expensive—or effectively impossible—to transfer.

That changes the economics of resilience.

A company that previously considered a billion-euro asset sufficiently protected because it was insured may discover that insurance is no longer a substitute for physical redundancy. A supplier may suddenly need greater liquidity because compensation could take months. A marketplace may find that losses borne by independent sellers cannot simply be transferred to an insurer.

The resilience premium then migrates again.

What began as a security problem becomes an insurance problem, then a working-capital problem, and finally an investment problem.

This is one reason insurance conditions deserve far more attention in geopolitical risk monitoring. Premiums tell only part of the story. Exclusions, deductibles, and limits can reveal where the market is quietly deciding that a risk has become harder to carry.

Refining the System

Energy infrastructure provides perhaps the clearest example of how physical destruction moves through several systems simultaneously.

On 30 October, another reported Ukrainian drone attack allegedly caused a fire at the Novokuybyshevsk refinery in Russia's Samara region. The Rosneft-owned facility can process approximately 8.8 million metric tons of crude annually. Russian Deputy Prime Minister Alexander Novak subsequently confirmed that three refineries and a gas-chemical complex had been attacked that day.

A refinery strike obviously concerns fuel production.

But stopping there misses most of the economics.

Reduced refining capacity can affect military logistics, domestic fuel availability, and industrial supply. Repairs require equipment, labor, and capital. Facilities need additional protection. Air-defense resources must be deployed around economically important sites. Replacement production has to come from somewhere else.

And Russian energy infrastructure has another function: it generates revenue for the state.

The cumulative objective of such strikes is not necessarily to destroy the entire system. Raising the cost of operating it can itself have strategic value. Russia must defend a geographically enormous network of refineries, terminals, depots, pipelines, and industrial plants against comparatively inexpensive long-range weapons.

Every additional layer of protection has an opportunity cost. Money spent defending a refinery cannot simultaneously be spent elsewhere. This is the logic of the resilience premium under wartime conditions.

The Five Payers

It is tempting to conclude that Russia simply pays for Ukrainian strikes against Russian infrastructure.

The reality is more complicated.

- **The first payer is the operator.** Rosneft, Ozon, Yandex, VK, or an electricity company absorbs physical damage, downtime, emergency response, rerouting, repairs, and new protective investment.
- **The second payer is the customer.** Households experience blackouts. Travellers experience disrupted flights. Marketplace customers experience cancellations. Digital users experience degraded services. Businesses dependent on those services absorb their own downstream disruption.
- **The third payer is the insurer (or the uninsured).** Some losses are transferred. Others remain with the operator, suppliers, or customers. As the risk environment deteriorates, the proportion that can economically be transferred may decline.
- **The fourth payer is the taxpayer.** Strategically important infrastructure rarely remains an exclusively private matter after repeated disruption. Governments may subsidize reconstruction, strengthen air defense, support strategically important companies, or finance additional infrastructure.

And then there is a **fifth payer** that is easier to overlook: **the neighboring system**.

Infrastructure disruption does not respect corporate or even national boundaries particularly well. Airspace restrictions, electronic warfare, displaced transport flows, cyber effects, energy-market reactions, and heightened military readiness can impose costs on countries that were never targets themselves.

The economic geography of a strike can therefore be much larger than its blast radius.

The Lessons

One does not need to be at war for the underlying vulnerability to exist.

Critical infrastructure already operates in an environment of sabotage, cyber operations, GPS interference, suspicious damage to undersea infrastructure, and other forms of hostile activity. The precise attribution and severity of individual incidents vary. The planning assumption, however, has changed: deliberate physical disruption can no longer be treated as an exotic scenario confined to active war zones.

The first lesson from Ukraine is to map infrastructure as a system rather than a sector.

Cybersecurity, energy security, physical security, and supply-chain continuity cannot be managed as separate disciplines if they depend on the same electricity, telecommunications, transport, and computing infrastructure.

A data center without independent power resilience is not resilient. A warehouse without alternative transport routes is not resilient.

A backup office connected to exactly the same telecommunications and cloud infrastructure as the primary office may not be much of a backup.

The second lesson is to search aggressively for hidden single points of failure.

Two suppliers may use the same upstream manufacturer. Two data centers may share the same grid connection. Multiple payment services may run on the same cloud platform. Alternative shipping routes may depend on the same port infrastructure.

Redundancy that shares the same dependency is partly an accounting fiction.

The third lesson is to treat insurance as a strategic variable.

Boards should understand not only whether critical assets are insured but what happens after a major loss: exclusions, deductibles, compensation limits, liquidity requirements, and the time needed to receive payment.

Insurance cannot replace continuity planning.

The fourth lesson is more uncomfortable. Commercial infrastructure can acquire strategic significance very quickly.

Data centers, telecommunications networks, warehouses, ports, energy facilities, and payment infrastructure can simultaneously serve civilian commerce and the functioning of the state. In a severe security crisis, the neat distinction between "commercial" and "strategic" infrastructure becomes increasingly difficult to sustain.

Companies do not have to agree with a belligerent's interpretation of their strategic relevance to be exposed to its consequences.

The Resilience Premium in Wartime

There is a final lesson that reaches directly into the central argument of this issue.

Resilience is not only about preventing failure. It is about deciding in advance how the cost of failure will be distributed.

Russia can harden substations, disperse inventories, build additional server capacity, strengthen air defenses, decentralize fuel storage, and protect warehouses.

All of these measures can make infrastructure harder to disrupt. All of them cost money. Doing nothing costs money, too, but only later, unpredictably, and often to different people.

That is the uncomfortable economics revealed by the Ukrainian deep-strike campaign.

Hit a substation and the consequences can reach a data center. Hit the data center and the effects can reach cloud customers, digital services, and corporate forecasts. Hit a warehouse and the damage moves from concrete and inventory into merchants, customers, and insurers. Hit a refinery and the consequences can move through fuel supplies, corporate capital expenditure, military logistics, government revenue, and diplomacy.

Infrastructure warfare does more than destroy infrastructure. It redistributes costs through it.

For companies and governments outside the war, that may be the most important lesson. The relevant question is not simply whether a critical facility can be attacked, sabotaged, or otherwise disrupted.

It is whether we understand everything connected to it before it fails—and whether we have decided who will pay when it does.

MISSION GREY GUILD

ANALYSIS · OCTOBER 2026

From Substation to Server Rack

How a Single Strike Moves Through Today's Infrastructure Stack



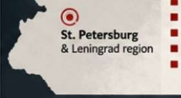
THE INFRASTRUCTURE STACK

Not separate sectors, but one interdependent system — where a strike in one layer quickly spreads through the rest.



FUEL & ENERGY	Refineries, terminals, fuel depots (power, mobility, military supply, revenue)
POWER	Grids, substations, backup capacity (keeps digital and logistical systems running)
DATA & DIGITAL	Data centers, cloud, platforms, payments (commerce, communications, operational control)
LOGISTICS & COMMERCE	Warehouses, fulfillment centers, platforms (connects sellers, inventory, and customers)
TRANSPORT & SERVICES	Airports, transport links, supply chains (people, goods, and critical operations)

THE ST. PETERSBURG STRIKE (18 OCTOBER)



- Oil terminal struck
- Fuel depot hit
- VK data center targeted
- Substation damaged
- Ozon warehouse hit
- ≈ 20,000 people without power
- Pulkovo airport disrupted (> 7 hours)

THE FINANCIAL IMPACT

Ozon	**30.1 billion rubles** loss provisions after attacks on 11 logistics facilities
Yandex	**Withdrew 2026 guidance** after data-center disruptions (incl. Sasovo)

THE COST SPREAD FAR BEYOND THE TARGET



WHO PAYS?

Operator	Damage, downtime, repairs, new protection
Customer / user	Blackouts, delays, cancellations, service disruption
Insurer	Claims, higher premiums, exclusions, deductibles
Taxpayer	Subsidies, reconstruction, wider security spending
Neighbouring system	Airspace, market, security and escalation costs

KEY LESSONS FOR EUROPEAN BUSINESS AND POLICY

- Map infrastructure as a **system**, not a sector.
- Identify hidden **single points of failure**.
- Treat insurance as a **strategic variable**.
- Recognise the strategic relevance of commercial platforms.
- Plan not only for survival, but for how the costs are distributed.

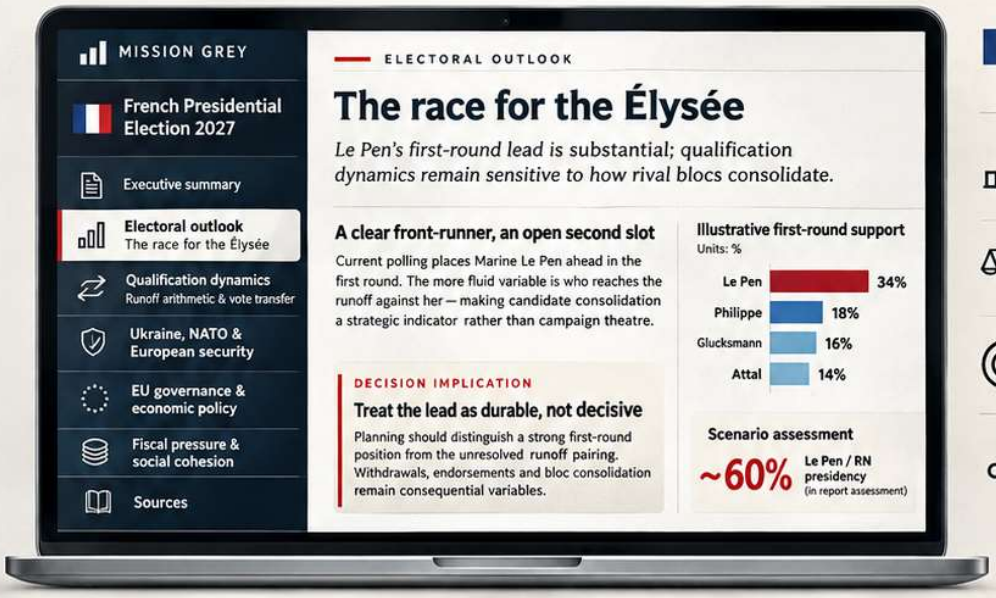
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EXTERNAL INTELLIGENCE PLATFORM

Turn a question into an interactive intelligence app.

Structured analysis, scenarios and decision implications – for the topics that matter to you.



Choose your topic > Generate the analysis > Explore scenarios & data > Monitor what changes



THE FRENCH ELECTION APP AT A GLANCE

Polling & scenarios
Latest figures and scenario assessments.

Policy analysis
EU, fiscal, security and domestic risks.

Decision focus
Clear business implications per topic.

Connected views
From election mechanics to market and operating risks.

THE FULL ANALYSIS COVERS FIVE CONNECTED TOPICS



1. Electoral outlook
The race for the Élysée and current polling.



2. Qualification dynamics
Runoff arithmetic and vote transfer.



3. Ukraine, NATO & European security
Support for Ukraine, NATO role and alliance cohesion.



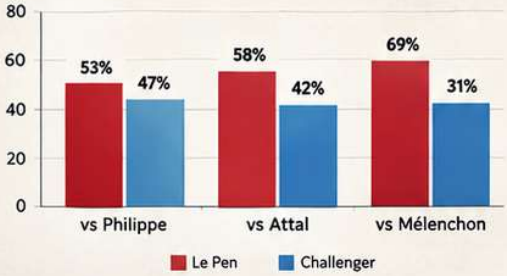
4. EU governance & economic policy
Potential friction with EU rules and institutions.



5. Fiscal pressure & social cohesion
Budget constraints, living costs and mobilization risk.

EXAMPLE: RUNOFF MATCHUPS

Illustrative vote shares in cited polling scenarios
Units: %



GENERATE YOUR OWN APP

The same intelligence structure can be built around your topic, for example:

- Supply-chain resilience
- Energy security
- Shipping corridors
- Technology competition
- Critical minerals
- Elections & political risk
- Market entry & country risk
- Regulation & policy change
- Security & conflict
- Climate, resources & ESG

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Monitoring	Continuous tracking of political, economic, regulatory and security developments.
Data Cleaning	Data quality checks, source verification, and factual consistency controls.
AI Analysis	AI-native processing, pattern detection and scenario generation.
Guild Expertise	Structured input from our network of domain and regional experts.
Validation	Expert review and challenge of results in high-impact cases.
Decision Output	A focused, actionable intelligence app with scenarios, data and clear implications.

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The resilience economy is redrawing globalization around trust, redundancy, and political acceptability. But shifting production, minerals, data, and logistics into new locations does not make dependency disappear. It creates new load-bearing nodes—and new questions about who carries the cost.

Redrawing Globalization

The old map of globalization was drawn largely around three variables: *cost, scale, and speed*.

Production gravitated towards places where factories could manufacture cheaply and at enormous volume. Inventories shrank. Suppliers clustered. Shipping networks concentrated around highly efficient ports and routes. Capital rewarded companies for extracting slack from the system.

The emerging map looks different.

Companies now ask whether a supplier is politically acceptable, whether a trade route can survive disruption, whether production can be duplicated, whether a country qualifies for industrial subsidies, and whether critical inputs can still be obtained during a geopolitical crisis.

This is usually described as *de-risking*, *friend-shoring*, *nearshoring*, or *China+1*.

Yet the terminology can obscure what is actually happening.

The resilience economy is not ending globalization. It is redrawing its map—and some of the new "safe" locations are becoming concentrated faster than policymakers admit.

Vietnam provides a useful starting point. It has been one of the clearest beneficiaries of supply-chain diversification away from China and ran a trade surplus with the United States of roughly $114 billion in the first half of 2026. But by the first nine months of the year, China was simultaneously Vietnam's largest source of imports. Production materials accounted for more than 94 per cent of Vietnam's total imports in the first half of 2026.

The apparent paradox is actually a description of modern globalization.

Vietnam can become more important as an alternative manufacturing location without becoming independent of the Chinese industrial ecosystem.

Diversification has occurred. Dependency has moved.

Manufacturing has also moved, but the upstream stack? Not necessarily.

Vietnam and India represent different versions of the same problem.

Vietnam has been exceptionally successful in attracting manufacturing and assembly that companies are seeking to diversify away from China. India is pursuing a much larger ambition: building domestic manufacturing ecosystems capable of competing for electronics, semiconductors, and other strategically important industries.

Both can genuinely improve resilience, but neither automatically eliminates upstream concentration.

India illustrates the problem particularly clearly. Government analysis has estimated that the country imports roughly 90–95 per cent of its semiconductor and electronic-component requirements, principally from China, Taiwan, South Korea, and Singapore. More granular research published in 2026 found that China supplied at least 80 per cent of India's imports in 71 electronics product categories, including important upstream components such as motors, cables, and switching equipment.

This produces one of the stranger consequences of de-risking.

India may require Chinese machinery, components, investment, or technical expertise in order to build the industrial capacity that will eventually make it less dependent on China.

There is nothing inherently contradictory about that strategy. Industrial ecosystems take decades to construct. But it exposes a distinction that corporate resilience strategies frequently overlook:

Geographic diversification is not the same as structural diversification.

Moving final assembly from China to Vietnam or India can reduce tariff exposure, political risk, and dependence on a single production location. Yet the new factory may still rely on Chinese machinery, intermediate components, chemicals, minerals, or engineering expertise.

The address changes, but the dependency survives further upstream.

For corporate boards, the implication is straightforward. Counting factories or direct suppliers is insufficient. What matters is how far upstream the alternative supply chain actually diverges from the original one.

Two suppliers are not necessarily two supply chains.

Resilience for Whom?

Indonesia reveals another dimension of the problem.

It has become indispensable to the global nickel economy. OECD analysis estimates that Indonesia accounted for almost **65 per cent of global nickel production in 2025** and around 43 per cent of processing. For companies attempting to secure batteries, electric vehicles, and other nickel-intensive supply chains, Indonesia is therefore impossible to ignore.

From one perspective, this is diversification. Processing and investment have moved closer to the mineral resource, while Indonesia has deliberately used export restrictions and industrial policy to force more value-added activity into the country.

But ownership complicates the picture. Indonesian companies control less than 10 per cent of nickel production, while companies with Chinese majority ownership control roughly 40 per cent. Significant quantities of intermediate material also continue to move to China, which dominates battery-grade processing further downstream.

The geography of production has changed without producing an equivalent change in the geography of corporate control.

This raises the question that should accompany every resilience strategy:

Resilience for whom?

For an automobile manufacturer in Europe, Japan, or South Korea, Indonesian nickel may diversify physical supply.

For Indonesia, the same arrangement can deepen dependence on foreign capital, technology, and customers.

And there is a wider cost. Expanding mining and processing requires electricity, ports, roads, water, industrial land, and environmental capacity. The host country absorbs those demands so that companies elsewhere can describe their supply chains as more resilient.

This does not make diversification misguided. Indonesia has obtained investment, industrial capacity, employment, and greater leverage from its nickel strategy.

It means that resilience is not neutral geography.

One country's supply security can become another country's infrastructure burden.

The Gulf Becomes a Resilience Hub

A different experiment is taking place in the Gulf.

The United Arab Emirates and Saudi Arabia increasingly sit at the intersection of several systems that companies and governments are attempting to make more resilient: energy, shipping, aviation, finance, cloud computing, and artificial intelligence.

Saudi Arabia has been expanding its maritime capabilities as it seeks a larger role in global logistics. According to Essam Alammari, Deputy for Maritime at the Saudi Transport general authority, Saudi Arabia's maritime fleet grew 34% in 2025, with its current carrying capacity reaching approximately 11.8 million tons, while the government explicitly described greater connectivity and route diversification as part of its supply-chain resilience strategy.

The UAE is simultaneously becoming a major capital and digital infrastructure hub. It attracted a record **$48.3 billion of inward foreign direct investment in 2025** and invested $63.4 billion abroad. Communications—including data centers and AI infrastructure—accounted for roughly 29 per cent of greenfield FDI capital expenditure. The country's installed data-center capacity exceeds 250 megawatts, with another 500 megawatts under development.

For companies seeking alternative logistics routes, capital, energy, or computing capacity, this is attractive. It is also precisely how new systemic nodes emerge. The same infrastructure that makes the Gulf valuable as an alternative makes disruption there increasingly consequential.

That vulnerability is no longer theoretical. Iranian officials told *Reuters* in October that Tehran had developed plans to target undersea communications cables in the Gulf in the event of renewed US or Israeli attacks. Iran has also threatened US-linked data centers and AI facilities in the region. Less than one per cent of global international bandwidth passes through the Strait of Hormuz, limiting the likely global communications impact of cable attacks there, but regional disruption could still affect cloud services, e-commerce, and financial transactions.

The paradox is striking. Investment intended to diversify global digital and commercial infrastructure increases the strategic importance of the place receiving it. A resilience hub gradually becomes something else: a concentration risk.

Nearer Is Not Necessarily Safer

Nearshoring rests on an intuitively compelling proposition: if long supply chains create vulnerability, move production closer.

Mexico demonstrates both the power and the limitations of this logic.

The country has become the largest foreign supplier of computer equipment to the United States. During the first seven months of 2026, shipments reached approximately **$90.8 billion**, giving Mexico 36.8 per cent of US imports in the category. S&P Global estimates that computer-server exports alone reached $82.9 billion in the first half of the year.

That is a remarkable industrial shift. It is also a reminder that proximity does not abolish infrastructure requirements.

Factories require reliable electricity. Industrial corridors require transport capacity. Suppliers require financing. Rapidly expanding electronics production needs water, skilled labor, logistics, and increasingly sophisticated power systems.

Thus, nearshoring moves part of the resilience premium onto the host economy.

Mexico must build and maintain the infrastructure that allows American supply chains to become more geographically secure.

Morocco plays a comparable role on Europe's southern edge.

Its automotive ecosystem has clustered around Tanger Med, where industrial zones connect manufacturers directly to one of the Mediterranean's major ports. Tangier Automotive City advertises delivery to northern

Europe in less than 48 hours, while Renault's nearby plant alone has production capacity of around 400,000 vehicles annually. New automotive and battery investments continue to arrive.

For European manufacturers, Morocco offers proximity, competitive production, and an alternative to longer Asian supply chains.

For Morocco, success means becoming increasingly important to European industrial continuity.

That is an opportunity, but also a dependency.

The distinction matters because **proximity reduces distance risk. It does not necessarily reduce concentration risk.**

If production accumulates around a handful of Mexican border corridors, Moroccan industrial zones, or strategically important ports, a shorter supply chain can still contain powerful single points of failure.

Whose Corridor Is It?

The same question becomes even more important in Africa.

The Lobito Corridor is often discussed as part of Western efforts to diversify critical mineral supply chains. The planned Zambia Lobito Railway would create an approximately 830-kilometre connection between **Zambia**'s Copperbelt and **Angola**'s existing Benguela railway, linking mineral-producing regions more efficiently with the Atlantic.

The developers estimate that the new route could reduce transit times to the port of Lobito from as much as 16 days to around seven.

That is a meaningful improvement in resilience.

But resilience for whom?

The Democratic Republic of the Congo produces roughly 70 per cent of the world's cobalt, while companies based in China own or operate as much as 80 per cent of the country's critical-mineral production, according to the US International Development Finance Corporation.

A new railway can diversify transport routes without necessarily changing mine ownership, processing capacity, or the destination of the minerals.

The distinction is fundamental.

A corridor can make extraction more resilient without making the producing economy more resilient.

If copper and cobalt simply reach global markets faster, the infrastructure may strengthen American, European, or Asian supply security while leaving the underlying economic structure of the producing countries largely unchanged.

The more ambitious version of resilience would ask different questions:

- How much processing happens locally?
- How much infrastructure serves the wider economy rather than exclusively the extractive corridor?
- Who owns the mines?
- Where does the value accumulate?
- And what happens to the host economy if global demand, technology, or political alliances change?

These questions are not arguments against the corridor. These are questions about whose resilience the corridor is ultimately designed to provide.

Brazil and the Countries That Do Not Fit the Map

Not every strategically important country fits comfortably into the vocabulary of *nearshoring* or *China+1*.

Brazil is useful precisely because it does not.

Its importance comes from a combination of food, minerals, energy, and industrial scale. Brazil attracted **$77 billion in foreign direct investment in 2025**, up from $63 billion the previous year. Meanwhile, 89 per cent of its electricity came from low-carbon sources, giving it an unusually clean electricity system for an economy of its size.

Countries like Brazil demonstrate why the emerging resilience economy cannot be understood simply as factories moving out of China.

The geography of resilience is also a geography of electricity, food, water, minerals, ports, political stability, and technological capability.

The countries possessing those assets acquire leverage, but also exposure.

As more countries become essential to other countries' resilience strategies, they become increasingly load-bearing parts of the global system.

The Paradox of the Safe Country

This leads to a problem that corporate diversification models rarely capture.

Imagine a country that looks unusually attractive as an alternative production location.

It is politically stable. Labor is competitive. The government welcomes investment. It has good ports. Trade agreements provide preferential market access.

Companies arrive. Then their suppliers arrive. Industrial parks expand. Housing grows around them. Electricity demand increases. Ports add capacity. Data centers appear. Banks finance the ecosystem. New roads and railways connect the cluster to international markets.

The diversification strategy works.

And precisely because it works, the country becomes more important.

Eventually, an alternative location can become a dependency in its own right.

Indonesia demonstrates this in nickel.

The Gulf increasingly demonstrates it in logistics, energy, and digital infrastructure.

Vietnam demonstrates it in export manufacturing.

Mexico is beginning to demonstrate it in the physical supply chain behind the AI economy.

This is the **paradox of the safe country**.

Successful diversification can create the next single point of failure.

Resilience for Whom?

None of this means that de-risking is an illusion.

Diversification matters. Additional suppliers matter. Alternative shipping routes matter. More distributed production matters. Strategic inventories matter.

The mistake is believing that these measures produce independence. They produce a different network of interdependence. And that network has distributional consequences.

A multinational corporation may accept slightly higher production costs in exchange for a second manufacturing base. Consumers may pay some of the difference. Shareholders may absorb lower margins.

But the host country may have to construct the electricity system, train the workforce, expand the port, supply the water, and accept the environmental burden that makes the corporation's resilience possible.

A new mine can improve battery security abroad while increasing commodity dependence at home. A data-center cluster can provide global cloud redundancy while straining the host country's grid. A manufacturing corridor can reduce dependence on one country while making another country's economy increasingly dependent on one industry.

Thus, resilience needs to be assessed from both ends of the supply chain.

For the buyer, the question is: have we diversified? For the producer, it may be: what have we become dependent on by becoming indispensable?

The New Map of Dependence

The global economy spent several decades building extraordinary concentrations because concentration was efficient.

It is now spending enormous sums trying to unwind some of them.

Production is moving. Inventories are increasing. New ports and railways are being constructed. Governments are subsidizing factories. Mining jurisdictions are gaining strategic importance. Cloud infrastructure is spreading into new regions.

This will make many systems more resilient, but dependencies will not disappear. They will migrate.

The appropriate objective is therefore not a world without dependencies. Such a world has never existed, and attempting to create one would be prohibitively expensive. The task is to understand dependencies early enough to prevent them from becoming invisible.

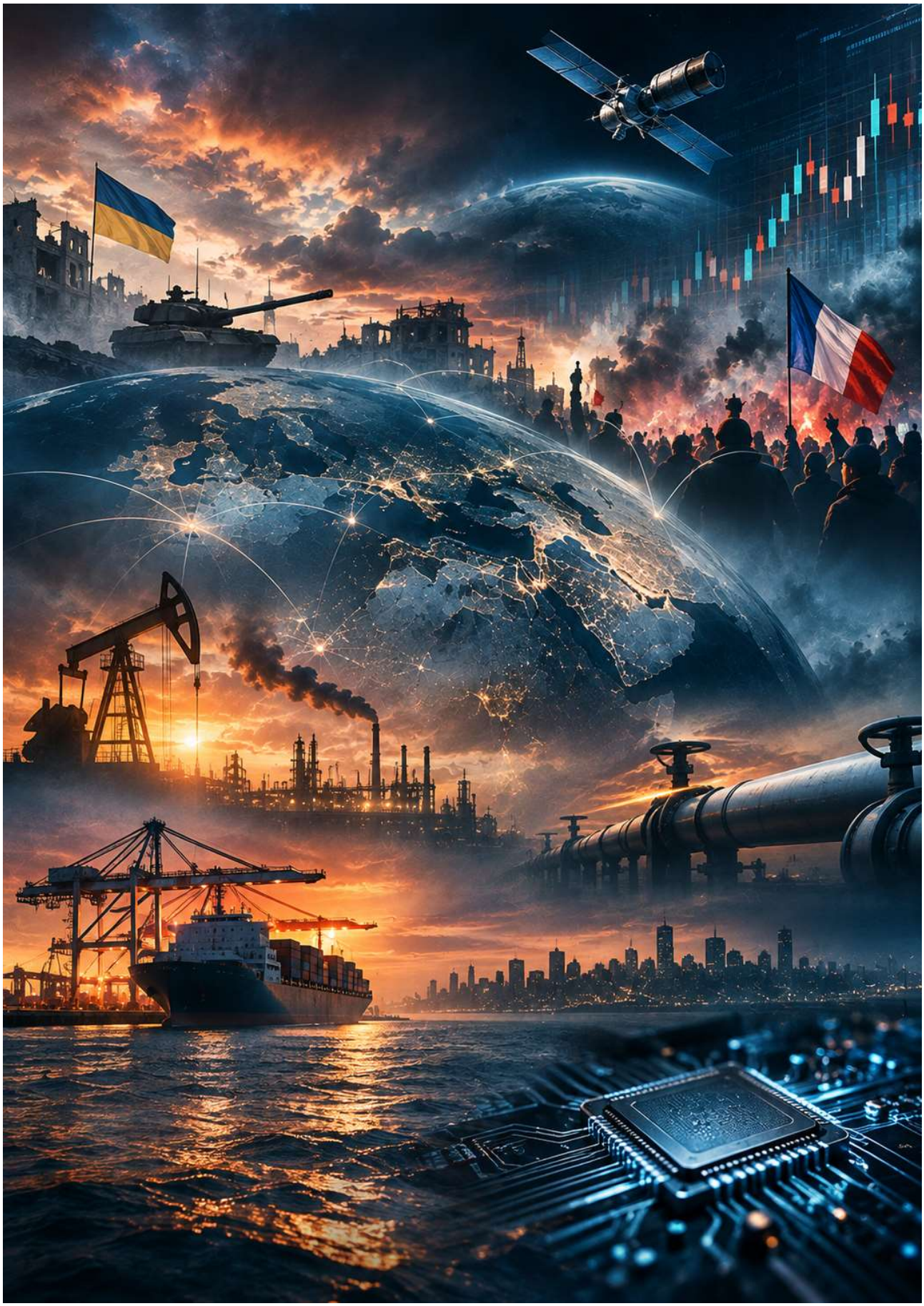
That means looking beyond the nationality of the immediate supplier to the origin of its components. Beyond the location of a mine to the ownership of its production. Beyond the existence of a second factory to the electricity, ports, and technologies on which both factories depend.

The resilience economy is redrawing globalization. In the end, the most important question could be the simplest one:

Dependent on whom, through what infrastructure, and at whose cost?

Because the next great concentration risk may not be yesterday's monopoly supplier.

It may be today's favored alternative.



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ELECTORAL OUTLOOK

Electoral Calendar: The Next 8 Months

Key elections to watch for business and investors • November 2026 – June 2027



	UNITED STATES MIDTERM ELECTIONS	EL SALVADOR GENERAL ELECTION	INDIA UTTAR PRADESH ASSEMBLY ELECTION	FRANCE PRESIDENTIAL ELECTION
DATE	3 November 2026	28 February 2027	Feb–Mar 2027 (expected)	April–May 2027
WHAT IS AT STAKE	All 435 House seats, 35 Senate seats, and 36 governorships. Control of Washington and the administration's room to maneuver.	Presidency, legislature and municipalities. First election after constitutional changes enabling indefinite reelection and a six-year term.	Control of Uttar Pradesh's assembly (403 seats) in India's most populous state — a key test for Prime Minister Modi's political strength ahead of 2029.	Election of the president for a five-year term. A decision on France's political direction, fiscal policy and the EU's strategic course.
OUTLOOK (CURRENT ASSESSMENT)	DEMOCRATIC HOUSE: LIKELY DEMOCRATIC SENATE: POSSIBLE	BUKELE REELECTION: ALMOST CERTAIN	BJP VICTORY: FAVORED	HIGHLY COMPETITIVE OUTCOME UNCERTAIN
BUSINESS IMPLICATIONS	■ Higher risk of budget standoffs and investigations under divided goverement. ■ Slower legislative flow and greater oversight. ■ Watch state outcomes: permitting, labor, data-center energy policy, and taxes.	■ Continued security-first agenda and further centralization likely. ■ Monitor legal predictability, judicial independence, and sanctions risk. ■ Higher rule-change risk.	■ A key indicator of Modi's national momentum and reform capacity. ■ Implications for infrastructure, energy, manufacturing, and the investment climate. ■ Watch regulatory continuity and state-level industrial policies.	■ Potential policy shifts on the budget, taxation, industrial policy, and energy (incl. nuclear). ■ Implications for EU integration, defense spending, and the broader regulatory climate. ■ Market sensitivity around fiscal discipline and political stability.

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- Supply chains & trade
- AI & compute infrastructure
- Energy & commodities
- Elections & political change
- Security, hybrid threats & sanctions
- Regulation & policy risk

CHOKEPOINT MONITORING



EXAMPLE ALERTS

- **Hormuz:** elevated disruption risk
  Shipping costs +18% (7d)
- **Malacca:** congestion rising
  Transit times +9% (7d)
- **Baltic:** infrastructure incident
  Heightened security monitoring

SCENARIO ANALYSIS



BUSINESS IMPACT

- ☑ Quantified risk scenarios
- ☑ Market and regulatory implications
- ☑ Operational and supply-chain effects
- ☑ Concrete options for decision-makers

SECTOR EXAMPLES


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Technology & data centres


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PVä	Pekka Väisänen	French and European political affairs.	
WV	William Vogt	Emerging markets and Sino-Lusophone affairs.	
PV	Pekka Virkki	Guildmaster; geopolitics, journalism and geopolitical analysis.	

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